



COLLEGE OF
**INFORMATION
TECHNOLOGY
AND COMPUTING**

FORMATTING AND SUBMISSION GUIDELINES FOR UNDERGRADUATE THESES AND CAPSTONE PROJECTS

1ST Edition

 citc@ustp.edu.ph

 ICT Building, USTP, Cagayan de Oro City

Table of Contents

General Guidelines	1
Section 1.1. Standard Formatting Guidelines	1
Section 1.2. Paper Specifications	1
Section 1.3. Page Margins	1
Section 1.4. Font Characteristics.....	1
Section 1.5. Paragraph Alignment	2
External Design and Structure.....	3
Section 2.1. Manuscript Binding	3
Section 2.2. Cover Color and Covering	3
Section 2.3. Letter Color	3
Section 2.4. Design and Layout of the Front Cover of Thesis Manuscripts.....	3
Section 2.5. Design and Layout of the Manuscript Spine of Thesis and Capstone Project Manuscripts	7
Preliminary Pages.....	8
Section 3.1. Contents of the Preliminary Pages.....	8
Section 3.2. Title Page.....	8
Section 3.3. Approval Page	12
Section 3.4. Acknowledgment	15
Section 3.5. Table of Contents	16
Section 3.6. List of Tables & Figures.....	18
Section 3.7. Acronyms and Abbreviations	19
Section 3.8. Abstract.....	20
Textual Presentation.....	22
Section 4.1. General Guidelines.....	22
Section 4.2. Text Structure	22
Section 4.3. Main Heading	25
Section 4.4. Major Subsection.....	26
Table Presentation.....	27
Section 5.1. Table Structure and Format	27
Section 5.2. Table Number and Title.....	27
Section 5.3. Format of Table Entries.....	28
Section 5.4. Table Footnote and Citation	29
Section 5.5. Table Presentation in the Text.....	30

Figure Presentation.....	31
Section 6.1. Figure Number and Title	31
Section 6.2. Figure Footnote and Citation	32
Section 6.3. Figure Presentation in the Text	32
Equation Presentation.....	34
Section 7.1. Equation Format.....	34
Section 7.2. Definition of Equation Terms.....	34
Section 7.3. Equation Number	35
Section 7.4. Equation Presentation in the Text	36
Pagination	37
Section 8.1. Pagination for Preliminary Pages	37
Section 8.2. Pagination for the Main Body	38
Section 8.3. Pagination for Landscape Pages.....	38
Appendix Presentation	39
Section 9.1. Appendix Format.....	39
Section 9.2. Appendix Letter, Number, and Title	39
In-Text Citation and Reference List.....	40
Section 10.1. General Format and Style.....	40
Section 10.2. Missing Reference Information.....	40
Plagiarism and AI-Generated Content Guidelines.....	41
Section 11.1. Plagiarism Policy	41
Section 11.2. AI-Generated Content Policy	42
Deed of Assignment for Ownership.....	43

ARTICLE 1

General Guidelines

Section 1.1. Standard Formatting Guidelines

The guidelines outlined in this section are considered the **standard formatting rules** and must be consistently applied throughout the entire manuscript. Any exceptions or modifications to these rules will be explicitly mentioned in relevant sections or paragraphs of subsequent articles.

Section 1.2. Paper Specifications

All manuscripts must be printed on **A4-sized** white bond paper. The paper dimensions should measure **297 mm in height and 210 mm in width**, with a minimum weight of **80 grams per square meter (gsm)** to ensure print quality and durability.

Section 1.3. Page Margins

Margins shall be measured from the edges of the page, adhering to the following specifications:

Top:	2.50 cm
Bottom:	2.50 cm
Right:	2.50 cm
Left:	3.80 cm

These margin dimensions ensure uniform spacing and readability throughout the manuscript.

Section 1.4. Font Characteristics

Unless otherwise specified, the following font settings must be consistently applied across the entire document, including page numbers:

- **Font Style:** Book Antiqua
- **Font Size:** 12 pt
- **Font Color:** Black
- **Text Style:** Regular (**not** bold, italicized, or underlined)
- **Scaling:** 100% (**do not** expand or condense text)
- **Spacing:** Normal (**avoid expanded or condensed letter spacing**)
- **Text Position:** Normal (**do not** raise or lower text positioning)

Section 1.5. Paragraph Alignment

1.5.1. Unless otherwise specified, all paragraphs shall be justified, meaning they will be aligned to both the left and right margins (see Example **1.5.2.**).

1.5.2. Example **1.5.2.**

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum

ARTICLE 2

External Design and Structure

Section 2.1. Manuscript Binding

All thesis and capstone project manuscripts must be hardbound prior to submission. Manuscripts that are soft bound, ring bound, or bound using any other method will not be accepted.

Section 2.2. Cover Color and Covering

2.2.1. Thesis manuscripts shall feature a **dark blue** hardbound cover. Use of crocodile-skin or similarly textured covers is prohibited.

2.2.2. Every manuscript must be encased in **transparent plastic** to provide added protection.

Section 2.3. Letter Color

All lettering on the manuscript spine and front cover must be gold, ensuring clear contrast against the dark blue cover.

Section 2.4. Design and Layout of the Front Cover of Thesis Manuscripts

2.4.1. The front cover page must include the following information:

2.4.1.1. Full thesis title

2.4.1.2. USTP Logo

2.4.1.3. Full name(s) of the author(s)

2.4.1.4. Degree, College, and University (written in full)

2.4.1.5. Date of manuscript submission

- 2.4.2.** The thesis title shall be in **uppercase letters** (with scientific names exempted) and center-aligned. It must be arranged in an inverse pyramid format, with the first line positioned approximately **5.0 cm** below the top edge of the cover.
- 2.4.3.** The authors' names shall be written in full—starting with the first name, followed by the middle name (not the middle initial), and then the surname. The names must be in **uppercase letters**, center-aligned, and ideally presented on a single line. They should be positioned about **12.5 cm** below the top edge of the cover. The sequence of names should reflect the order agreed upon by the authors and approved by the adviser/panel of examiners.
- 2.4.4.** The degree shall be written in full (e.g., **BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN DATA SCIENCE**, not B.S. DATA SCIENCE or BS DATSCI), in **uppercase letters**, center-aligned, and placed on a single line. It should appear approximately **9.0 cm** above the bottom edge of the cover. This will be followed by **COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTING** and **UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY OF SOUTHERN PHILIPPINES** (and address of which campus) (refer to Pattern [2.4.6](#) and Example [2.4.7](#) for further details) .
- 2.4.5.** The date of manuscript submission shall indicate the month and year when the numerical grades were submitted by the advisers to the registrar's office. This date must be in **uppercase letters** and center-aligned (e.g., for first semester: **JANUARY 2025**; for second semester: **JUNE 2025** or **MAY 2025**; for mid-year: **JULY 2025**). It is important to note that regardless of when the manuscript is submitted during the semester, the date displayed should correspond to the grade submission date at the semester's end. This date should be positioned about **5.0 cm** above the bottom edge of the front cover (refer to Pattern [2.4.6](#) and Example [2.4.7](#) for further details) .

2.4.6. Pattern 2.4.6.

12.5 cm

5.0cm

**TITLE IN UPPERCASE AND BOLD LETTERS
INVERSE PYRAMID STYLE**

5.0 x 5.0 cm

USTP
UNIVERSITY OF
SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY
OF SOUTHERN PHILIPPINES

**AUTHOR'S FULL NAME (1)
AUTHOR'S FULL NAME (2)
AUTHOR'S FULL NAME (3)
AUTHOR'S FULL NAME (4)**

9.0 cm

**BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN _____
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTING
UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY OF SOUTHERN PHILIPPINES
CAGAYAN DE ORO CITY, 9000, PHILIPPINES**

MONTH AND YEAR OF MANUSCRIPT SUBMISSION

2.50 cm

2.4.7. Example 2.4.7.

**GRAPH NEURAL NETWORKS FOR IMAGE CLASSIFICATION:
EVALUATING THE IMPACT OF SEGMENTATION AND
GRAPH TOPOLOGY ON MODEL PERFORMANCE**



**ANGELIE SABANAL ABAO
JHUN BRIAN MATIC ANDAM
ALBERT CHRISTOPHER DANLOT II
MATTHEW REAL MAULION**

**BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN DATA SCIENCE
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTING
UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY OF SOUTHERN PHILIPPINES
CAGAYAN DE ORO CITY, 9000, PHILIPPINES**

JANUARY 2025

Section 2.5. Design and Layout of the Manuscript Spine of Thesis and Capstone Project Manuscripts

2.5.1. The manuscript spine shall contain the following information:

2.5.1.1. The acronym 'CITC'

2.5.1.2. Acronym of the degree

2.5.1.3. Surname(s) of the author(s) arranged according to Section 2.4.3.

2.5.1.4. Year of manuscript submission

2.5.2. The top and bottom edges of the spine shall be bordered by two gold lines as indicated in Pattern 2.5.8.

2.5.3. The acronym 'CITC' shall be bordered by two gold lines positioned 2.5 cm below the top edge of the spine. It should be centered between these lines and the lines at the top edge of the spine (see Pattern 2.5.8. and Example 2.5.9.).

2.5.4. The acronym of the degree (BS____) should be positioned about 5.0 cm below the top edge of the spine.

2.5.5. For consistency, the following terms shall be used to indicate the acronym of the different degrees:

2.5.5.1. BSCS for BS in Computer Science

2.5.5.2. BSDS for BS in Data Science

2.5.5.3. BSIT for BS in Information Technology

2.5.5.4. BSTCM for BS in Technology Communication Management

2.5.6. The year of manuscript submission should be positioned about 5.0 cm above the bottom edge of the spine.

2.5.7. On the spine of the hardbound manuscript, only the surname of the author shall be included. It should be separated by commas if there are multiple authors. The text must be in uppercase letters and centered on the spine.

2.5.8. The authors' surnames shall be placed between the degree acronym and the year of manuscript submission on the spine of the hardbound manuscript.

2.5.9. Pattern 2.5.9.:



2.5.10. Example 2.5.10:



ARTICLE 3

Preliminary Pages

Section 3.1. Contents of the Preliminary Pages

3.1.1. The preliminary pages for all manuscripts (arranged according to their order of presentation in the text) include the following:

3.1.1.1. TITLE PAGE

3.1.1.2. APPROVAL PAGE

3.1.1.3. ACKNOWLEDGMENT

3.1.1.4. TABLE OF CONTENTS

3.1.1.5. LIST OF TABLES

3.1.1.6. LIST OF FIGURES

3.1.1.7. LIST OF APPENDICES

3.1.1.8. ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS (if applicable)

3.1.1.9. ABSTRACT

3.1.2. Each preliminary page shall be started on a new page, regardless of the space left in the previous page.

Section 3.2. Title Page

3.2.1 The title page shall contain the following information:

- Full thesis title
- Statement of submission
- Full name of the authors
- Statement of partial fulfillment of degree requirements
- Degree
- Date of manuscript submission

3.2.2 All items found in the title page shall be presented in bold letters.

3.2.3 The title shall be in uppercase letters (except for scientific names), center-aligned in the page and shall be laid out in an inverse pyramid manner. The first line of the title shall be positioned at the topmost line of the page.

3.2.4 The **statement of submission** must be written in **uppercase letters, center-aligned**, and formatted in accordance with the layout specified in **Pattern 3.2.5**. The first line of the statement should be positioned approximately **five (5) spaces** below the author's name to maintain proper alignment and readability.

3.2.5 Pattern 3.2.5.

SUBMITTED TO THE FACULTY OF THE

 DEPARTMENT
 COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTING
 UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY OF SOUTHERN PHILIPPINES

3.2.6 The blank line in Pattern 3.2.5. shall correspond to the academic department where the authors belong. For consistency, the following names shall be used to indicate the department:

3.2.6.1 Department of Computer Science

3.2.6.2 Department of Data Science

3.2.6.3 Department of Information Technology

3.2.6.4 Department of Technology Communication Management

3.2.7 The author(s) name(s) shall be written in full, first name first, followed by middle name (not middle initial), and then surname. It shall be presented in uppercase letters, center-aligned in the page, and in single line only. The author's name shall be positioned about five (5) spaces below the last line of the statement of submission.

3.2.8 The statement of partial fulfillment of degree requirements shall be in uppercase letters, center-aligned in the page and stated according to the format and layout illustrated in Pattern 3.2.9. The first line in the statement of partial fulfillment of degree requirements should be positioned about five (5) spaces below the name of the author.

3.2.9 Pattern 3.2.9.

IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF
 THE REQUIREMENTS FOR
 THE DEGREE OF

3.2.10 The degree shall be written in full, (e.g. BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN DATA SCIENCE not B.S. DATA SCIENCE nor BS DATSCI), in uppercase letters, center-aligned in the page, and preferably, in single line only. The degree should be positioned about three (3) spaces below the last line of the statement of partial fulfillment of degree requirements

3.2.11 The date of manuscript submission shall correspond to the month and year when the numerical grade of the student in their thesis.

3.2.12 The title page shall have an imaginary page number.

3.2.13 Pattern **3.2.13. Note:** In this pattern, the number of spaces between word groups, as shown by the symbol ¶, is for illustration purposes only. The actual number of spaces will depend on length of the title and the presence/omission of the lines for divisions and majors. It should be emphasized, however, that the requirements of Sections **3.2.1** to **3.2.12** shall still be followed. See also Examples **3.2.14** to **3.2.15**.

TITLE IN UPPERCASE AND BOLD LETTERS INVERSE PYRAMID STYLE ¶ ¶ ¶ ¶ ¶ SUBMITTED TO THE FACULTY OF THE DEPARTMENT COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTING BY ¶ ¶ ¶ AUTHOR'S FULL NAME AUTHOR'S FULL NAME AUTHOR'S FULL NAME AUTHOR'S FULL NAME ¶ ¶ ¶ IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS FOR THE DEGREE OF ¶ ¶ ¶ BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN _____ ¶ ¶ ¶ MONTH AND YEAR OF MANUSCRIPT SUBMISSION

3.2.14 Example 3.2.14.: Title page

**GRAPH NEURAL NETWORKS FOR IMAGE CLASSIFICATION:
EVALUATING THE IMPACT OF SEGMENTATION AND
GRAPH TOPOLOGY ON MODEL PERFORMANCE**

**SUBMITTED TO THE FACULTY OF THE
DEPARTMENT OF DATA SCIENCE
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTING
BY**

**ANGELIE SABANAL ABAO
JHUN BRIAN MATIC ANDAM
ALBERT CHRISTOPHER PANGANTIHON DANIOT II
MATTHEW REAL MAULION**

**IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE
REQUIREMENTS FOR THE
DEGREE OF**

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN DATA SCIENCE

JANUARY 2025

Section 3.3. Approval Page

3.3.1 The contents of the approval page shall be laid-out in such a way that all information shall be contained in one (1) page only as illustrated in Pattern **3.3.2**, which is the **FM-USTP-ACAD-11**

3.3.2 Pattern 3.3.2 **FM-USTP-ACAD-11**

	UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY OF SOUTHERN PHILIPPINES		Document Code No. FM-USTP-ACAD-11						
	Alubijid Balubal Cagayan de Oro Claveria Jasaan Oroquieta Panaon Villanueva		<table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr> <th style="text-align: center;">Rev. No.</th> <th style="text-align: center;">Effective Date</th> <th style="text-align: center;">Page No.</th> </tr> <tr> <td style="text-align: center;">01</td> <td style="text-align: center;">12.01.21</td> <td style="text-align: center;">1 of 1</td> </tr> </table>	Rev. No.	Effective Date	Page No.	01	12.01.21	1 of 1
	Rev. No.	Effective Date	Page No.						
01	12.01.21	1 of 1							

APPROVAL SHEET

This Thesis entitled: _____ prepared
and submitted by _____ in partial
fulfillment of the requirements for the degree _____
_____ has been examined and approved.

Adviser

PANEL OF EXAMINERS

Approved by the committee on Oral Examination with a grade of PASSED.

Chair

Member

Member

Approved and accepted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree

Approved:

Name and Signature of Dean/Campus Director

Date of Final Defense

3.3.3 The **approval page** must begin with a paragraph formally stating that the manuscript has been **accepted and approved** by the designated signatories. This introductory paragraph shall include the following details, presented in **uppercase and bold letters**:

3.3.3.1 Full thesis title

3.3.3.2 Full name(s) of the author(s)

3.3.3.3 Degree of the author(s)

3.3.4 Pattern **3.3.4.**:

The Thesis entitled: “**THESIS or CAPSTONE PROJECT TITLE**”, prepared and submitted by **AUTHOR’S FULL NAMES** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **DEGREE** has been examined and approved.

3.3.5 Example **3.3.5.**

The Thesis entitled “**GRAPH NEURAL NETWORKS FOR IMAGE CLASSIFICATION: EVALUATING THE IMPACT OF SEGMENTATION AND GRAPH TOPOLOGY ON MODEL PERFORMANCE**”, prepared and submitted by **ANGELIE SABANAL ABAO, JHUN BRIAN MATIC ANDAM, ALBERT CHRISTOPHER PANGANTIHON DANIOT II, MATTHEW REAL MAULION** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN DATA SCIENCE** has been examined and approved.

3.3.6. The format and layout for the space where the signatories shall sign are illustrated in Pattern **3.3.7.**

3.3.7. Pattern **3.3.7.**

FULL NAME OF SIGNATORY

Designation

3.3.8. The name of the signatory shall be written in full (with middle initial) and in uppercase and bold letters. For consistency, pre-nominal titles like “Prof.”, “Engr.”, “Dr.”, “Mr.”, etc, shall not be included in the signatory’s name. However, postnominal titles like “PhD”, “CPA”, “MIT”, etc, are encouraged.

3.3.9. For consistency, the following terms shall be used to indicate the designation of the signatory:

- | | |
|------------------|----------------------|
| 3.3.9.1. Member | for Panel members |
| 3.3.9.2. Adviser | for advisers |
| 3.3.9.3. Chair | for Panel Chairs |
| 3.3.9.4. Dean | for the college dean |

3.3.10. The line above the name of the signatory shall be kept similar in length for all the signatories. If possible, the length of the said line should be equal to the length of the name of the signatory with the longest name. The name and designation of the signatory shall be center-aligned relative to this line.

3.3.11. To illustrate the format prescribed by the preceding paragraphs, Examples [3.3.12.](#) to [3.3.14.](#) should be considered.

3.3.12. Example [3.3.12.](#): Panel Member

AL-MONTE VINCE M. CALO, DIT
Member

3.3.13. Example [3.3.13.](#): Adviser

JOCELYN B. BAROSA, PhD
Adviser

3.3.14. Example [3.3.14.](#): College Dean

JUNAR A. LANDICHO, PhD
Dean
College of Information Technology and Computing

3.3.15. The names of the signatories shall be arranged and laid out in the page according to the format illustrated in Patterns [3.3.2.](#) In rare instances when the name of the signatories are too long to be laid-out opposite to each other, the author is granted flexibility to introduce modifications to the approval page (e.g. reduce the font size to 11, slightly decrease the margins, etc.), provided that the lay-out is still maintained. NOTE: See the full list of current CITC administrators and faculty members in USTP Website.

3.3.16. The approval page shall have an imaginary page number.

3.3.17. The approval page shall be printed by the authors and signed by all the signatories using WET signatures. When submitting electronic copies of manuscripts, the signed hardcopy of the approval page shall be converted into an electronic format (i.e. scanned into a .pdf format) and shall be inserted to the electronic version of the manuscript to be submitted to academic units and libraries.

Section 3.4. Acknowledgment

- 3.4.1** The title “ACKNOWLEDGMENT” shall be positioned at the topmost line of the page, center aligned and in uppercase and bold letters.
- 3.4.2** Three (3) spaces shall be maintained between the title and the first line of the first paragraph.
- 3.4.3** There is no prescribed line spacing for this section but the font size and page alignment (justified) shall be maintained.
- 3.4.4** The acknowledgment shall be limited to five (5) pages only.
- 3.4.5** Preferably, the acknowledgment should be in pure English. However, Filipino words may be used provided that they will be italicized or enclosed in quotations marks as they appear in the text. If possible, bold and underlined words or phrases shall not appear in the body of the acknowledgment.
- 3.4.6** The acknowledgment may be written in first or third person point of view.
- 3.4.7** Pictures or figures of any kind are prohibited in the acknowledgment. Likewise, inappropriate colloquial words are not permitted.
- 3.4.8** Pattern 3.4.8.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

¶
¶
¶

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit,
 sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna
 aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation
 ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis
 aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum
 dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat
 cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit
 anim id est laborum.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit,
 sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna
 aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation
 ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis
 aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum
 dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat
 cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit
 anim id est laborum.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit,
 sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna
 aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation
 ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis
 aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum
 dolore eu

page

Section 3.5. Table of Contents

- 3.5.1** The title “TABLE OF CONTENTS” shall be positioned at the topmost line of the page, center aligned and in uppercase and bold letters.
- 3.5.2** Two (2) columns shall be created where the items and their corresponding page numbers are listed. The first column shall contain the list of the items to be included and such column shall not contain any heading. All the contents of the first column shall be flushed to the left margin.
- 3.5.3** The second column shall contain the heading “PAGE”, underlined and in uppercase letters. This heading shall be four (4) spaces below the line containing the title “TABLE OF CONTENTS.”
- 3.5.4** The first item in the list (e.g. TITLE PAGE) shall be three (3) spaces below the line containing the heading “PAGE”.
- 3.5.5** Dots or dashes connecting the items to their corresponding page numbers shall be omitted.
- 3.5.6** Page numbers shall be listed under and “centered” relative to the heading “PAGE” (see Example 3.5.7.).
- 3.5.7** Example 3.5.7.

TABLE OF CONTENTS	
	<u>PAGE</u>
TITLE PAGE	i
APPROVAL SHEET	ii
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	iii

- 3.5.8** Double spaces shall be maintained between entries but single space should be maintained within entries.
- 3.5.9** The headings and sections to be listed in the table of contents shall have the same case formatting as what is found and prescribed in the text.
- 3.5.10** Major subsections shall be indented 1.25 cm to the right reckoned from the main heading. Likewise, minor subsections shall be indented 1.25 cm to the right relative to the major subsection. Paragraph headings shall be indented 1.25 cm to the right relative to the minor subsection.

3.5.11 Example **3.5.11**.

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE	10
2.1 Section A	10
2.2 Section B	12
2.2.1 Subsection 1	15
2.2.1 Subsection 2	17

3.5.12 Usually, the “TABLE OF CONTENTS” exceeds one page, and in such a case, the list shall be continued in succeeding pages and the line containing the heading “PAGE” shall still appear in each page.

3.5.13 Example **3.5.13**.

	<u>PAGE</u>
	¶
	¶
3.8 Section X	50
RESULTS AND DISCUSSION	51
4.1 Section Y	51
4.2 Section Z	55

3.5.14 Only the title “TABLE OF CONTENTS” shall be bold and the remaining entries and page numbers shall be in their regular formatting.

Section 3.6. List of Tables & Figures

- 3.6.1** Tables and figures presented in the main text shall appear in the “LIST OF TABLES” and “LIST OF FIGURES”, respectively.
- 3.6.2** The title of the list (e.g. “LIST OF TABLES”) shall be positioned at the topmost line of the page, center aligned and in uppercase and bold letters.
- 3.6.3** Three columns shall be created where the items and their corresponding page numbers are listed. The first column shall contain the number of the items to be included. This column shall contain the appropriate heading (“TABLE” OR “FIGURE”), underscored and in uppercase letters.
- 3.6.4** The second column shall contain the list of the items to be included and such column shall not contain any heading. All the contents of the second column shall be flushed to the left margin of that column.
- 3.6.5** The third column shall contain the heading “PAGE”, underscored and in uppercase letters. The headings shall be four (4) spaces below the line containing the title of the list.
- 3.6.6** The first item in the list shall be three (3) spaces below the line containing the column headings (see Example 3.6.7.)
- 3.6.7** Example 3.6.7.

LIST OF TABLES		
<u>TABLE</u>		<u>PAGE</u>
1.1	Characteristics of GNN	4
2.1	Model Performance Summary	13
4.1	Classification Report of Out-of-Scopes Classes	41

- 3.6.8** The first item in the list shall be three (3) spaces below the line containing the column headings.
- 3.6.9** Table or figure numbers shall be listed under and “centered” relative to their respective headings. Likewise, page numbers shall be listed under and “centered” relative to the heading “PAGE”.

- 3.6.10** Double spaces shall be maintained between entries but single space should be maintained within entries.
- 3.6.11** In cases where the items or titles are too long, they shall be cut in such a way that the top line is always longer than the succeeding lines.
- 3.6.12** The headings and sections to be listed in the list shall have the same case formatting as what is found and prescribed in the text

Section 3.7. Acronyms and Abbreviations

- 3.7.1** This preliminary section shall be created only if the combined number of acronyms and abbreviations to be included in the list is at least five (5). If the number is below five, it is recommended that the items are defined instead in the body of the main text, specifically in the sections where they were first introduced or mentioned.
- 3.7.2** Symbols used to represent variables and constants in equations shall not be included in the list of acronyms and abbreviations.
- 3.7.3** There shall only be one list of acronyms and abbreviations, i.e. they shall not be segregated into 'Acronyms' or 'Abbreviations'. The items shall be listed alphabetically, regardless if the item starts with an uppercase letter or a lowercase letter.
- 3.7.4** The title "ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS" shall be positioned at the topmost line of the page, center aligned and in uppercase and bold letters.
- 3.7.5** Two (2) columns shall be created where the acronyms/abbreviations and their corresponding meanings are listed.
- 3.7.6** The first column shall contain the alphabetical list of acronyms and abbreviations. When reckoned from the left margin of the page, the width of the first column should be around 3.5 cm to 4.7 cm.
- 3.7.7** The second column shall contain the corresponding meanings of the acronyms/abbreviations. When reckoned from the right edge of the first column, the width of the second column should be around 10.0 cm to 11.2 cm.
- 3.7.8** The first entry in the list shall start four (4) spaces below the title "ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS". All entries should be flushed to the left side of the column. Double spaces shall be maintained between entries but single space should be maintained within entries.
- 3.7.9** Only the title shall be bold and the other entries shall be in their regular formatting.

3.7.10 Example 3.7.10.

ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS	
AMD	Advanced Micro Devices
BSB	Bank State Branch
.	.
.	.
.	.
CITC	College of Information Technology and Computing
CITL	Center for Innovative Teaching and Learning
DDS	Department of Data Science
3.5 cm to 4.7 cm 10.0 cm to 11.2 cm	

Section 3.8. Abstract

The Abstract serves as a concise summary of the research, providing an overview of the study's objectives, methodology, key findings, and conclusions. It must be written in a structured and clear manner to allow readers to quickly grasp the essence of the manuscript.

3.8.1. General Formatting

The Abstract must adhere to the following formatting specifications:

- Length: The abstract should be between 150 to 250 words and must fit within a single page.
- Alignment: Justified.
- Spacing: Single-spaced, with no paragraph indentation.
- Margins: Follow the standard manuscript margins
- Language: The abstract must be written in English, in a clear and concise manner, avoiding unnecessary jargon and overly complex terminology.

3.8.2. Content Structure

The Abstract should follow a structured format while remaining in a single continuous paragraph:

- Introduction/Background: A brief statement of the research problem or motivation.
- Objective: The main aim of the study.
- Methods: A summary of the research methodology, including key techniques, datasets, or system implementations.
- Results: The most significant findings or contributions.
- Conclusion: A summary of the research implications or recommendations for future work.

3.8.3. Keywords

Following the abstract, include a list of 3 to 5 keywords, separated by commas, relevant to the research topic. Keywords should be in lowercase, except for proper nouns or acronyms, and should not be italicized or bolded.

3.8.4. Prohibited Elements

- No citations, references, or footnotes.
- No tables, figures, or mathematical equations.
- No subheadings or bullet points within the abstract text.

ARTICLE 4

Textual Presentation

Section 4.1. General Guidelines

4.1.1. The main body of the manuscript, encompassing sections from **INTRODUCTION** to **RECOMMENDATIONS**, should be written in the **third-person point of view** to maintain an objective and formal tone.

4.1.2. Each paragraph must begin with a **1.25 cm indentation** from the left margin. The text should be **fully justified**, ensuring uniform alignment along both the left and right margins. Additionally, **double spacing** must be applied throughout the document, including the space between paragraphs, to enhance readability and maintain consistency.

4.1.3. To uphold a **professional and polished presentation**, the use of unnecessary marks, symbols, or embellishments within the text should be avoided. **Underlining** must not be used for term definitions or emphasis, as standard formatting conventions recommend alternative methods such as **italicization or bold text** where necessary.

Section 4.2. Text Structure

4.2.1. The document should maintain a maximum of **three levels of subsections**:

- **Major subsection**
- **Minor subsection**
- **Paragraph headings**

4.2.2. Major subsections shall be:

- **Left side** on the page
- Written in **bold letters**
- Capitalized in **title case** (first letter of all significant words capitalized)
- When it runs more than half the page, it shall be cut off, with the longer line at the top, and flush to the left margin in single space (see Example [4.2.10.](#)).
- There shall be **four (4) spaces** between the **main heading** and the **first line of the major subsection**

4.2.3. The **minor subsection** shall be placed **three (3) spaces** below the major subsection. It shall be positioned at the **left side** of the page, in **bold letters**, with the first letter of all significant words capitalized. When it runs more than half the page, it shall be cut off, with the longer line at the top, and flush to the left margin in single space (see Example **4.2.10.**).

4.2.4. Paragraph headings shall be indented 1.25 cm inch to the right followed by a period. The paragraph immediately follows after two (2) spaces.

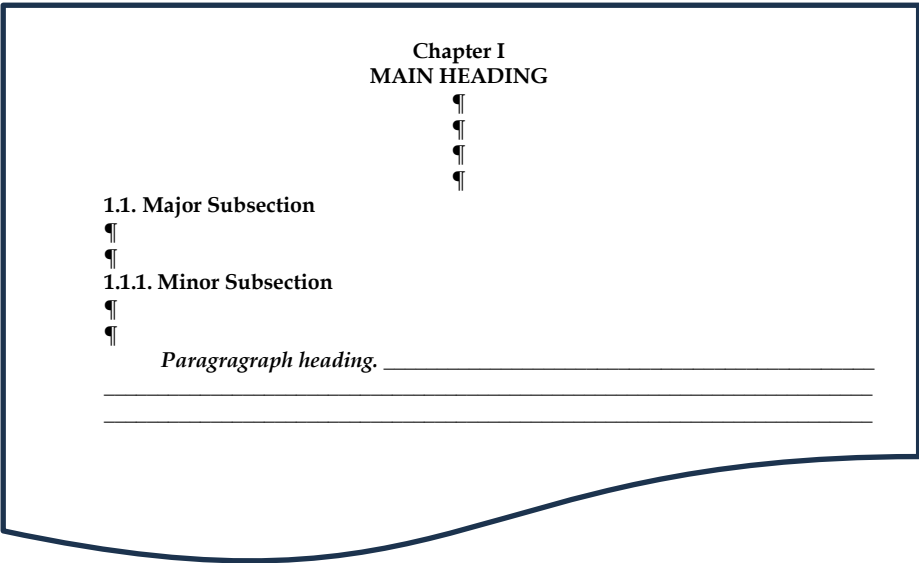
4.2.5. Paragraph headings shall be bold and *italicized* with only the first letter of the first word capitalized (sentence case).

4.2.6. The **paragraph heading** shall be three (3) spaces below the minor subsection.

4.2.7. The **main headings, major subsections, and minor subsections** are numbered according to the format presented in Sections **4.3** and **4.4**. Paragraph headings are unnumbered.

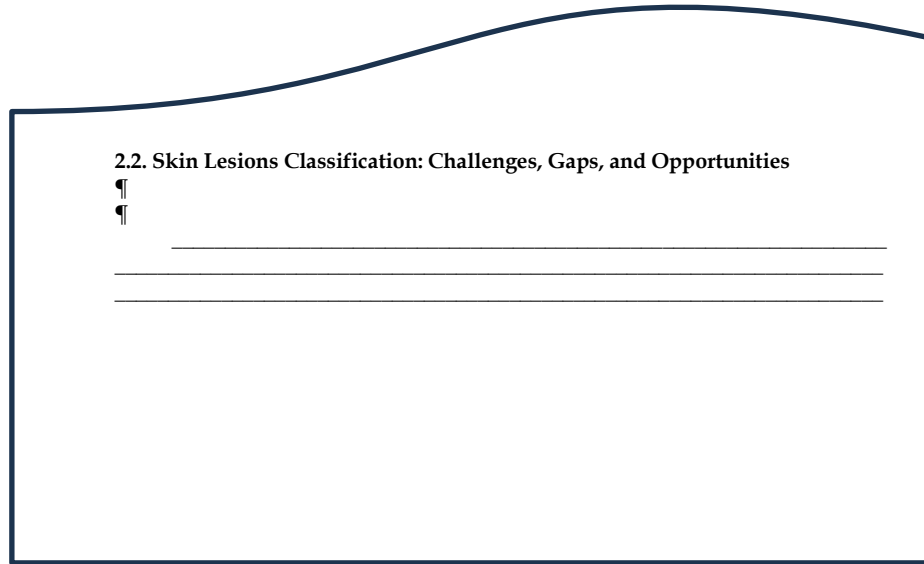
4.2.8. To fully illustrate the format concerning textual presentation, the following structure in Pattern **4.2.9.** shall be adopted throughout the text:

4.2.9. Pattern **4.2.9.**



4.2.10. Example 4.2.10.

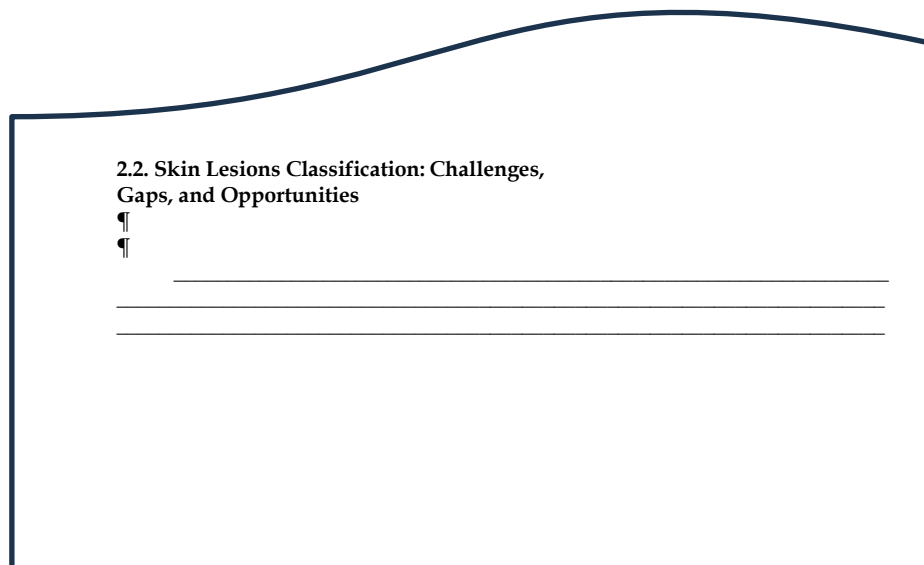
Original



2.2. Skin Lesions Classification: Challenges, Gaps, and Opportunities

- ¶
- ¶
- ¶

Preferred



2.2. Skin Lesions Classification: Challenges, Gaps, and Opportunities

- ¶
- ¶
- ¶

Section 4.3. Main Heading

4.3.1. The **main headings** in thesis and capstone project manuscripts must correspond to the designated chapters of the main text. Each chapter heading shall follow this format:

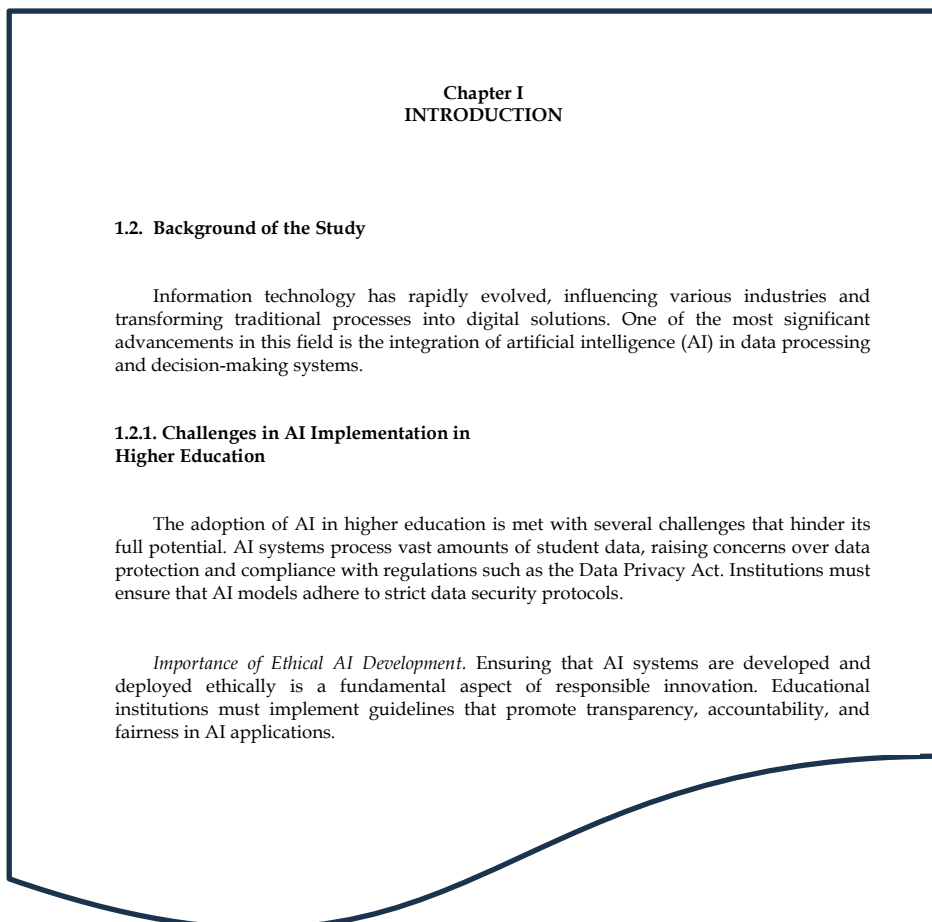
Chapter [Roman Numeral] (*topmost line, centered, bold, uppercase*)
CHAPTER TITLE (*centered, bold, uppercase*)

The preferred main headings titles are as follows:

- INTRODUCTION
- REVIEW OF LITERATURE
- METHODOLOGY
- RESULTS AND DISCUSSION
- SUMMARY AND CONCLUSION
- RECOMMENDATIONS
- REFERENCES (not numbered as a chapter but formatted similarly as a main heading)

4.3.2. Each **chapter must begin on a new page**, regardless of any remaining space on the previous page. See Example 4.3.3

4.3.3. Example 4.3.3



Section 4.4. Major Subsection

4.4.1. For all manuscripts, the preferred major subsections for the INTRODUCTION are, but not limited to:

- 4.4.1.1.** 1.1. Background of the Study
- 4.4.1.2.** 1.2. Significance of the Study
- 4.4.1.3.** 1.3. Objectives of the Study
- 4.4.1.4.** 1.4. Scope and Limitations of the Study

4.4.2. “Statement of the Problem” can also be included in the INTRODUCTION.

4.4.3. Major subsections should be numbered according to the list in Section [4.4.1](#). Major subsections vary depending on the chapter where they belong. However, they shall be formatted according to the provisions of this article. See Example **4.3.3**

ARTICLE 5

Table Presentation

Section 5.1. Table Structure and Format

5.1.1. To fully illustrate the format concerning table presentation, the table structure in Pattern **5.1.2.** shall be adopted throughout the manuscript:

5.1.2. Pattern 5.1.2.

FIRST LEVEL HEADING	FIRST LEVEL HEADING (unit)	FIRST LEVEL HEADING		
		Second Level Heading		Second Level Heading (unit)
		third level heading (unit)	third level heading (unit)	
Row Heading 1				
Row Heading 2				
Row Heading 3				

5.1.3. Tables shall not contain side boxes, instead, they shall be presented with single solid lines (lineweight = 1 pt) as top and bottom borders.

5.1.4. The use of too many lines in the table should be avoided. Single solid horizontal lines should be used to separate the different rows and to separate the headings from the entries.

5.1.5. First level headings shall be in uppercase letters. Significant words in the second level headings shall have their first letters capitalized. All third level headings shall have lowercase letters except for proper nouns and acronyms. Dimensions and units are exceptions to these rules, i.e. they shall be presented in their proper formats and symbols, enclosed in parentheses

Section 5.2. Table Number and Title

5.2.1. Tables shall be numbered consistently and continuously, independent of the numbering of figures and the numbering of equations.

5.2.2. Table numbers are composed of two numbers separated by a dot. The first number corresponds to the number of the chapter where the table belongs while the second number corresponds to the number of the table as it appears in the chapter.

5.2.3. Table titles shall be preceded by the label “Table X.X” (not “Tab. X.X”) followed by a period. The title immediately follows after two (2) spaces.

5.2.4. The table title shall be placed at the top of the table and shall be in sentence case (i.e. only the first letter of the first word is capitalized, and the whole title is followed by a period). A single space shall be maintained between the last line of the table title and the top line border of the table.

5.2.5. The table title shall be positioned relative to the page. For consistency, the table title, including the label “Table X.X.” shall be aligned to the left margin.

5.2.6. If the title length exceeds the page width, the title shall be cut off, and the remaining part is aligned to the start of the label, in single space.

5.2.7. Example **5.2.7.**

Table 3.2. Performance Comparison of Different Computing Systems Based on Processing Speed and Energy Consumption

SYSTEM	TRADITIONAL		CLOUD-BASED	
	Processing Speed (GHz)	Energy Consumption (W)	Processing Speed (GHz)	Energy Consumption (W)

Section 5.3. Format of Table Entries

5.3.1. All entries, including headings, shall be single-spaced within a cell and shall be centered vertically.

5.3.2. If possible, entries should also be centered horizontally. However, phrases are preferably flushed to the left margin.

5.3.3. Consistency on the format of values and entries shall be observed. In a column or row populated by numerical values, the number of decimal places shall be the same in each cell, depending on the desired accuracy.

5.3.4. Example **5.3.4.**

Table 3.5. Computational Performance of ML Models at Different Training Dataset Sizes.

TRAINING DATASET SIZE (samples)	MODEL PERFORMANCE (Accuracy %)		
	SVM	CNN Model	GNN Model
500	85.42	89.24	87.01
1000	88.60	91.92	91.07
1500	90.75	94.60	93.90
2000	92.83	97.28	96.00
2500	94.12	98.96	98.22

Section 5.4. Table Footnote and Citation

- 5.4.1** Footnotes to be included in the table shall be positioned below the bottom double line border, single-spaced and flushed to the left edge of the table (see Example 5.4.3.).
- 5.4.2** For tables sourced from references, the source shall be indicated below the bottom double line border (or footnote, if any), flushed to the left edge of the table and in italics. The source shall contain the author and year of publication (see Example 5.4.4.).
- 5.4.3** Example 5.4.3.

Table 3.8. Mean Processing Time Observed in Different Algorithms*.

ALGORITHM	PROCESSING TIME (ms)	
	Dataset A	Dataset B
1	12.34	12.98
2	11.89 ^a	11.66
3	11.91 ^a	11.62
4	12.10	12.82

*In a column, means followed by the same letter are not significantly different at $p < 0.05$.

5.4.4. Example 5.4.4.

Table 3.4. Physical and Chemical Properties of Alternative Fuel Sources.

FUEL TYPE	ENERGY CONTENT (MJ/kg)	MOISTURE CONTENT (%)	ASH CONTENT (%)
Corn Stover	14.0	15-25	6.0
Wheat Straw	13.5-15.0	10-20	5.5
Rice Straw	12.0-14.5	9-18	7.2
Sawdust	15.5-18.0	8-12	0.5-1.0
Bamboo Residues	16.0	8-10	1.5
Sugarcane Bagasse	13.0-14.0	40-50	2.0
Pine Needles	17.0	7.5	1.8
Coconut Shell	18.5	6.0	0.7
Eucalyptus Bark	15.0	10-15	3.5
Almond Shells	19.2	5.0	0.3-0.9

Source: dela Cruz et al., 2023

Section 5.5. Table Presentation in the Text

- 5.5.1 Tables can be presented **after** they are mentioned in the text or they could be placed as appendix.
- 5.5.2 Tables shall be aligned to the left margin. They could be placed along with the text or could be in a separate page. If placed with the text, three (3) spaces shall be maintained between the table title and the last line of the preceding text. Likewise, three (3) spaces shall also be provided between the bottom of the table and the first line of the succeeding text.

5.5.3 Pattern 5.5.3.

_____ in Table X-__.

Table X-__.

FIRST LEVEL HEADING	FIRST LEVEL HEADING (unit)	FIRST LEVEL HEADING		
		Second Level Heading		Second Level Heading (unit)
		third level heading (unit)	third level heading (unit)	
Row Heading 1				
Row Heading 2				
Row Heading 3				
Row Heading 4				
Row Heading 5				

ARTICLE 6

Figure Presentation

Section 6.1. Figure Number and Title

6.1.1. Figures shall be numbered consistently and continuously, independent of the numbering of tables and the numbering of equations.

6.1.2. Figure numbers are composed of two numbers separated by a dot. The first number corresponds to the number of the chapter where the figure belongs while the second number corresponds to the number of the figure as it appears in the chapter.

6.1.3. Figure caption shall be preceded by the label “Figure Y.Y.” (not “Fig. Y.Y”) followed by a period. The caption immediately follows after two (2) spaces.

6.1.4. The caption shall be placed at the bottom of the figure and shall be in sentence case (i.e. only the first letter of the first word is capitalized, and the whole caption is followed by a period). A single space shall be maintained between the bottom edge of the figure and the first line of the figure caption.

6.1.5. The figure caption shall be positioned relative to the page. For consistency, the figure caption, including the label “Figure Y.Y.” shall be aligned to the left margin.

6.1.6. The guidelines stated in the preceding provisions are exemplified in Example [6.1.7.](#)

6.1.7. Example [6.1.7.](#)

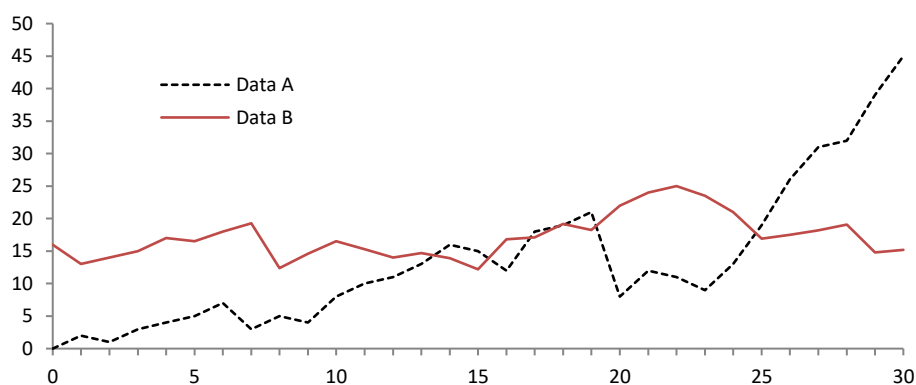


Figure 4.3. Comparative analysis of two datasets.

Section 6.2. Figure Footnote and Citation

6.2.1. Footnotes shall be positioned immediately after the figure caption. It shall be introduced by the italicized term “*Note:*” and the note shall follow after two (2) spaces

6.2.2. For figures sourced from references, the source shall be indicated after the figure caption (or note, if any). The source shall contain the author (or title) and year of publication and it shall be introduced by the italicized term “*Source:*” (see Example 6.2.3.).

6.2.3. Example 6.2.3.

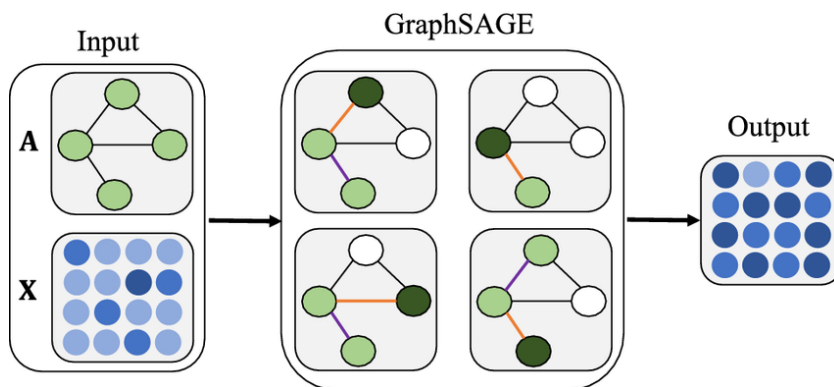


Figure 3.4. GraphSage Architecture. *Source:* Stanford University, 2006.

Section 6.3. Figure Presentation in the Text

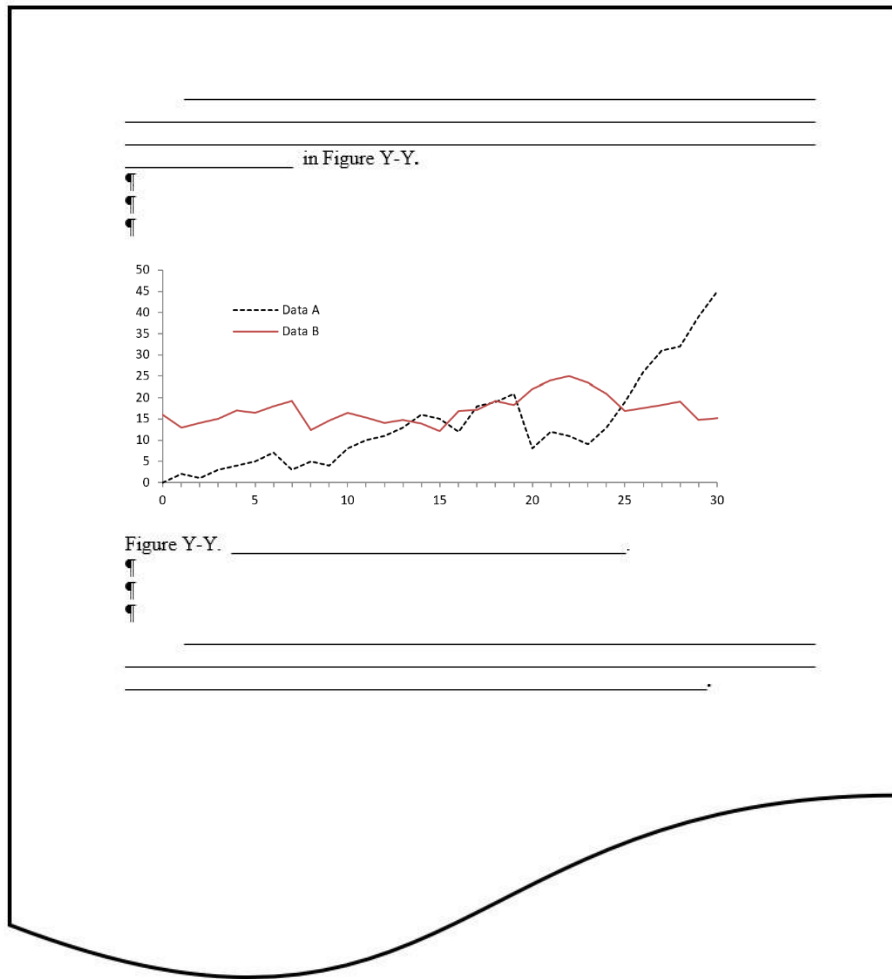
6.3.1. Figures shall be clear and do not contain unnecessary marks. Preferably, figures should be printed in colored ink.

6.3.2. Preferably, figures should not be enclosed by borders.

6.3.3. Figures can be presented **after** they are mentioned in the text or they could be placed as appendix figures.

6.3.4. Figures shall be aligned to the left margin. They could be placed along with the text or could be in a separate page. If placed with the text, three (3) spaces shall be maintained between the top edge of the figure and the last line of the preceding text. Likewise, three (3) spaces shall also be provided between the figure caption and the first line of the succeeding text.

6.3.5. Pattern 6.3.5.



ARTICLE 7

Equation Presentation

Section 7.1. Equation Format

7.1.1. Equations between quantities are preferred over equations between numerical values. Equations shall be expressed in their mathematically correct form.

7.1.2. The variables shall be represented by letters or symbols, the meanings of which are explained in connection with the equation.

7.1.3. All the terms in the equations shall be italicized. However, the definition of terms shall be presented in normal format.

7.1.4. As far as possible, symbols having more than one level of subscript or superscript shall be avoided (see Example [7.1.5.](#)).

7.1.5. Example **7.1.5.**

$Q_{l,max}$ is preferable to $Q_{l_{max}}$

Section 7.2. Definition of Equation Terms

7.2.1. Each term in the equation, whether a constant or a variable, shall be defined after the equation is presented. For variables requiring a specific unit, the unit shall be enclosed in parenthesis and shall be placed at the end of the definition.

7.2.2. The definition of terms shall be introduced by the word “where:” followed by an enumeration of the terms with their corresponding definitions. The word “where” shall be flushed to the left margin of the page and shall be positioned three (3) spaces below the last line of the equation.

7.2.3. The list of terms shall be single-spaced and all flushed to the left margin (see Example [7.2.4.](#))

7.2.4. Example 7.2.4.

$$L = 2C + \frac{\pi}{2}(D_L + D_S) + \frac{(D_L - D_S)^2}{4C}$$

¶

¶

where:

L is the belt pitch length for an open drive

C is the center to center distance

D_S is the pitch diameter of small pulley

D_L is the pitch diameter of large pulley

π is the number 3.1415926. . .

Section 7.3. Equation Number

7.3.1. Equations shall be numbered consistently and continuously, independent of the numbering of tables and the numbering of figures.

7.3.2. Equation numbers are composed of two numbers separated by a dash. The first number corresponds to the number of the chapter where the equation belongs while the second number corresponds to the number of the equation as it appears in the chapter.

7.3.3. The equation number shall be preceded by the label “Equation Z-Z” (not “Eqn. Z-Z”). The equation number and label shall be italicized and enclosed in parentheses.

7.3.4. The equation number shall be flushed to the right margin of the page, directly opposite the equation it describes.

7.3.5. Example 7.3.5.

$$T_R = \frac{F d_m}{2} \frac{(L + \pi f d_m)}{\pi d_m - f L} \quad (\text{Equation 3-11})$$

¶

¶

where:

T_R is the torque required to lift the axial load

F is the axial load carried by the screw

d_m is the screw mean diameter

f is the coefficient of friction between the nut and the screw

L is the screw lead

π is the number 3.1415926. . .

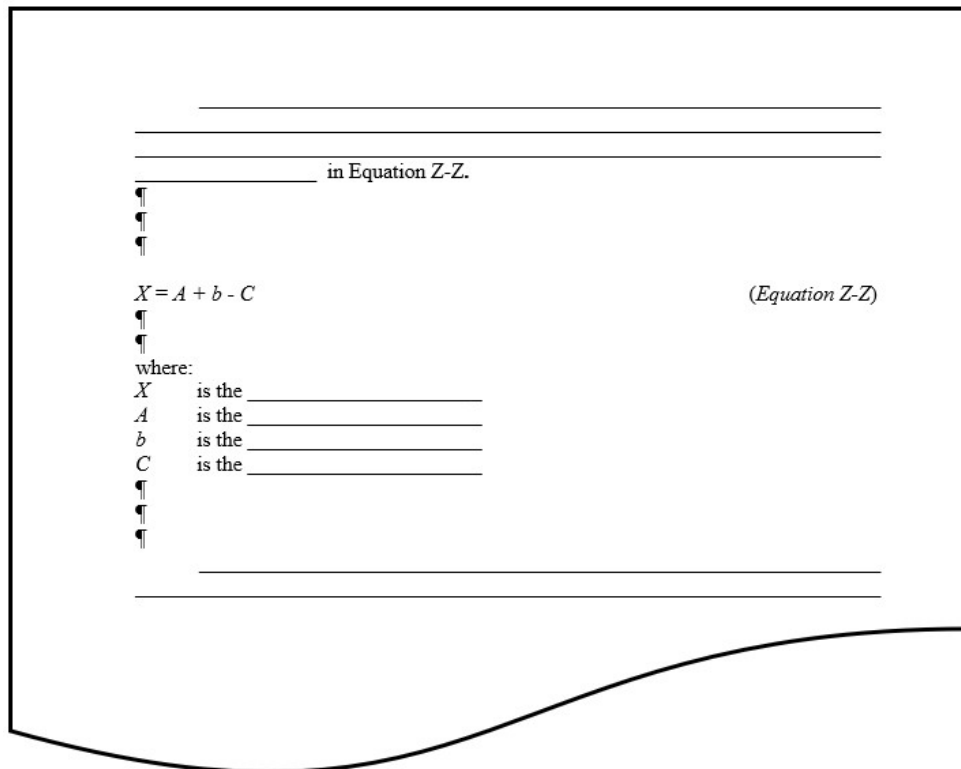
Section 7.4. Equation Presentation in the Text

7.4.1. Equations can be presented **after** they are mentioned in the text or they could be placed in the appendix.

7.4.2. Equations shall be aligned to the left margin. If placed with the text, three (3) spaces shall be maintained between the first line of the equation and the last line of the preceding text. Likewise, three (3) spaces shall also be provided between the last defined term of the equation and the first line of the succeeding text.

7.4.3. If the equation is too long, it shall be cut off in such a way that it retains its correct form and meaning.

7.4.4. Example 7.4.4.



ARTICLE 8

Pagination

Section 8.1. Pagination for Preliminary Pages

- 8.1.1. Preliminary pages shall contain lowercase roman numeral page numbers.
- 8.1.2. Page numbers shall be positioned at the bottom of each page, center-aligned and placed 1.25 cm inch from the bottom edge of the page.
- 8.1.3. The TITLE PAGE and the APPROVAL PAGE shall have imaginary page numbers.
- 8.1.4. Example 8.1.4.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my deepest gratitude to my advisor, [Advisor's Name], for their invaluable guidance, continuous support, and patience throughout the research process. Their expertise and insightful feedback greatly contributed to the development of this thesis.

My heartfelt appreciation also goes to my panel members, [Panelist 1], [Panelist 2], and [Panelist 3], for their constructive criticism and encouragement, which helped refine this study.

A special thanks to my family and friends, whose unwavering support and motivation kept me going during challenging times. Their encouragement and belief in my abilities were instrumental in completing this research.

Lastly, I extend my sincere gratitude to [Institution/Organization] and all individuals who provided assistance, resources, and encouragement throughout this academic journey. This work would not have been possible without your support.

iii } 1.25 cm

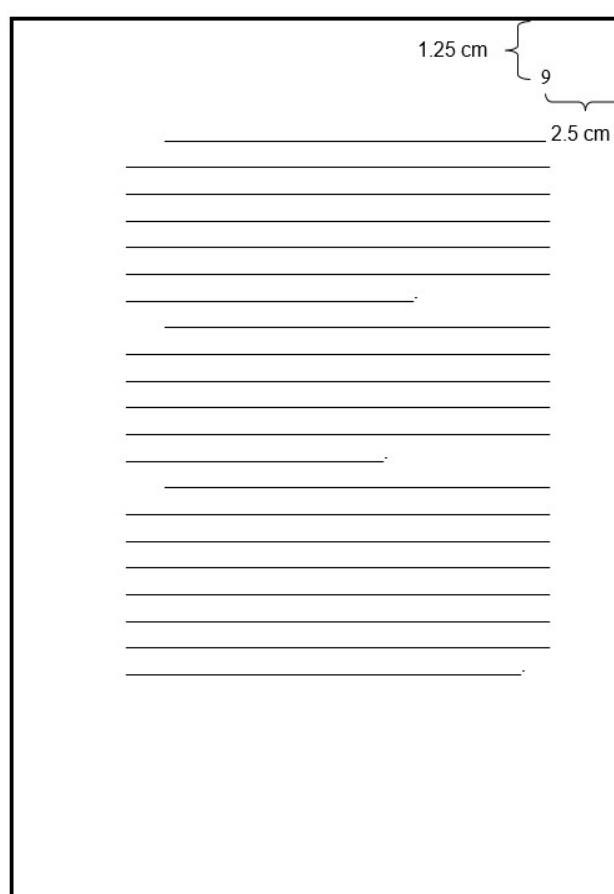
Section 8.2. Pagination for the Main Body

8.2.a. The main body of the manuscript shall contain arabic numeral page numbers.

8.2.b. Page numbers shall be positioned at the upper right corner of the page, positioned 2.5 cm from the right side and 1.25 cm from the topside.

8.2.c. Pages containing the main headings (INTRODUCTION, REVIEW OF LITERATURE, THEORETICAL BACKGROUND, MATERIALS AND METHODS, RESULTS AND DISCUSSION, SUMMARY AND CONCLUSION, RECOMMENDATIONS, REFERENCES, APPENDICES) shall have imaginary page numbers.

8.2.d. Example 8.2.d.



Section 8.3. Pagination for Landscape Pages

8.3.1. Page number format, orientation and sequence of landscape pages shall conform to the provisions presented in Section 8.2.

8.3.2. It shall be emphasized that in landscape pages, the orientation, and location of the page number shall still follow the format. In addition, the page number shall conform to the existing page sequence in the manuscript. Authors are strongly encouraged to explore options so that the provisions of this section are followed.

ARTICLE 9

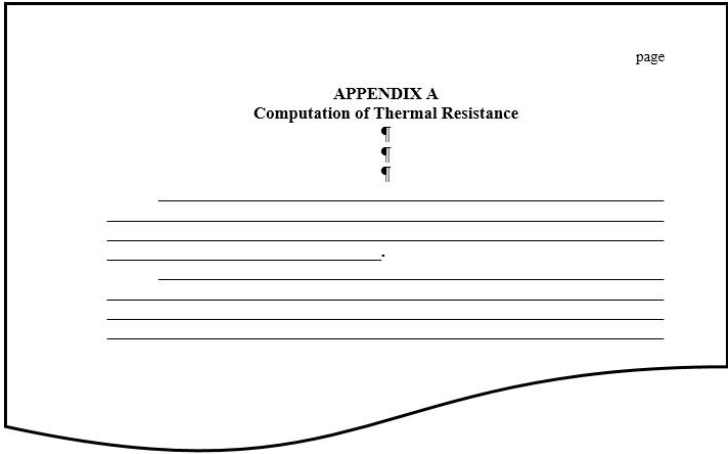
Appendix Presentation

Section 9.1. Appendix Format

The items that are included in the appendices shall be formatted according to the guidelines governing the presentation of texts, tables, figures, and equations.

Section 9.2. Appendix Letter, Number, and Title

- 9.2.1. Appendices shall be lettered chronologically starting from “APPENDIX A”.
- 9.2.2. The heading “APPENDIX ____” shall be positioned at the topmost line of the page, center aligned and in uppercase and bold letters.
- 9.2.3. The appendix title shall be positioned at the center of the page, below the heading “APPENDIX ____”, in bold letters, and with the first letter of all significant words capitalized.
- 9.2.4. If the appendix title is composed of five or more words, it shall be arranged in an inverted pyramid form, in single space.
- 9.2.5. Three (3) spaces shall be maintained between the last line of the appendix title and the first line of the first paragraph.
- 9.2.6. Example 9.2.6.



ARTICLE 10

In-Text Citation and Reference List

Section 10.1. General Format and Style

10.1.1. All manuscripts shall use the American Psychological Association (APA) style of bibliographic citation. Specifically, authors are expected to use the style prescribed in the latest edition of the APA Publication Manual. The most recent version is the Seventh (7th) edition (APA 7) published in 2020.

10.1.2. APA uses the "Author-Date" style of parenthetical and narrative citation.

10.1.3. It should be emphasized that authors are responsible for all information in their reference list and in-text citations. The adviser/panel of examiners is expected to verify the accuracy of the bibliographic entries.

Section 10.2. Missing Reference Information

In creating a reference entry, four elements are usually present: author, date, title of the work, and source. In cases where elements are missing, the following template should be used:

Missing Element	Solution	Reference List Entry	In-Text Citation
Nothing (all elements are present)	Provide the author, date, title, and source of the work.	Author. (Date). <i>Title</i> . Source.	(Author, year); Author (year)
Author missing	Provide the title, date, and source.	<i>Title</i> . (Date). Source.	(<i>Title</i> , year); <i>Title</i> (year)
Date missing	Provide the author, write "n.d." for "no date," and then provide the title and source.	Author. (n.d.). <i>Title</i> . Source.	(Author, n.d.); Author (n.d.)
Title missing	Provide the author and date, describe the work in square brackets, and then provide the source.	Author. (Date). [Description of work]. Source.	(Author, year); Author (year)
Author and date missing	Provide the title, write "n.d." for "no date," and then provide the source.	<i>Title</i> . (n.d.). Source.	(<i>Title</i> , n.d.); <i>Title</i> (n.d.)
Author and title missing	Describe the work in square brackets, and then provide the date and source.	[Description of work]. (Date). Source.	([Description of work], year); [Description of work] (year)
Date and title missing	Provide the author, write "n.d." for "no date," describe the work in square brackets, and then provide the source.	Author. (n.d.). [Description of work]. Source.	(Author, n.d.); Author (n.d.)
Author, date, and title missing	Describe the work in square brackets, write "n.d." for "no date," and then provide the source.	[Description of work]. (n.d.). Source.	([Description of work], n.d.); [Description of work] (n.d.)
Source missing	Cite as a personal communication or find another work to cite.	No reference list entry	(C. C. Communicator, personal communication, month day, year); C. C. Communicator (personal communication, month day, year)

Adapted from APA 7, 2020

ARTICLE 11

Plagiarism and AI-Generated Content Guidelines

Section 11.1. Plagiarism Policy

Plagiarism is the act of using another person's work, ideas, or intellectual property without proper attribution. It is strictly prohibited and includes, but is not limited to:

- Copying text, images, code, or data from published sources without citation.
- Paraphrasing or summarizing ideas without proper acknowledgment.
- Submitting work previously submitted for another course or institution without authorization.
- Unauthorized collaboration or using another student's work.

11.1.1. Plagiarism Check Requirement

- All submissions must undergo plagiarism detection through **[Turnitin/ Grammarly/ Institutional Software]**.
- The **acceptable similarity index** is **30% or lower**, excluding references, direct quotes, and properly cited content.
- Works exceeding the allowable similarity index will be subject to review, revision, or possible disqualification.

11.1.2. Proof of Plagiarism Check

A **Plagiarism Check Certificate** must be attached as **Appendix**, generated from the plagiarism detection tool used. It should include:

- Thesis/capstone project title
- Similarity percentage
- Date and time of the plagiarism check
- Signature of the adviser confirming authenticity

11.1.3. Consequences of Plagiarism

- **Minor offenses** (e.g., improper citations) may require revisions and resubmission.
- **Major offenses** (e.g., intentional copying) may result in a failing grade, disciplinary action, or disqualification.

Section 11.2. AI-Generated Content Policy

The use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools, such as ChatGPT, Grammarly, and QuillBot, must be approached with academic integrity.

11.2.1 Permitted Use of AI:

- AI tools may assist with grammar and style enhancement, brainstorming, and organization of thoughts.
- AI may assist in code debugging (for programming-based projects) as long as the original problem-solving approach is documented.
- AI-generated summaries of sources must be cross-verified with the original material.

11.2.2. Prohibited Use of AI:

- AI-generated text, research findings, or full sections of the thesis without critical human input.
- Directly copying AI-generated responses as final content.
- AI-generated citations or fabricated references.
- Using AI to create false data, experimental results, or misrepresented analyses.

11.2.3. AI Disclosure Requirement

Students must submit an AI Disclosure Certificate (include it as Appendix), stating the extent of AI usage in their research and writing. This certificate must include:

- AI tools used (e.g., Grammarly, ChatGPT, QuillBot)
- Purpose of AI use (e.g., grammar checking, idea generation)
- A declaration that no AI-generated content was submitted without verification
- Signature of the student and adviser

11.2.4. Review and Verification

- Faculty advisers and thesis panels reserve the right to assess the originality and authenticity of submitted work.
- If AI use is suspected beyond acceptable limits, students may be required to revise their work or justify their methodology.
- Failure to disclose AI usage when required may be considered academic misconduct and subject to disciplinary action.

ARTICLE 12

Deed of Assignment for Ownership
